



Merciless: Bayern Munich's Harry Kane delivered a 14-minute hat-trick against RB Leipzig. REUTERS

spoilsport. Ahead of the new season, little suggests that narrative will change.

Defending champion Barcelona opened its campaign in style with a 3-0 win against Mallorca, with Raphinha, Ferran Torres and Lamine Yamal on target. In its second match against Levante, however, the Catalans were made to work much harder as they had to come from behind to pick up three points. Goals from Ivan Romero and Jose Luis Morales put Levante 2-0 up before the break, but Hansi Flick's half-time team talk worked wonders for the second half.

Pedri pulled one back in the 49th minute before Ferran equalised in the 52nd. With no further goals until the 90th minute, all signs pointed to a draw, but in a stroke of luck for Barca and misfortune for Levante,

Unai Elgezabal scored an own goal in stoppage time to gift three points to Hansi Flick's side.

Real Madrid, under new manager Xabi Alonso, started on a positive note, beating Osasuna 1-0 courtesy of a Kylian Mbappe penalty.

Los Blancos followed it up with a dominant 3-0 win against Oviedo, with Mbappe grabbing a brace and Vinícius Júnior adding a late third.

Diego Simeone endured a poor start as Atletico Madrid lost 1-2 against Espanyol in its opener and only managed a 1-1 draw against Elche in the following week.

The Basque clubs, Athletic Bilbao and Real Sociedad, avoided defeat in the opening round, with the former beating Sevilla 3-2 and the latter drawing 1-1 against Valencia.

Sociedad's wait for its first win continued as it was held 2-2 by Espanyol, while Athletic had yet to play its second game at the time of writing.

Villarreal currently leads the table with six points after wins against

Oviedo and Girona. Barcelona and Real Madrid, also on six points, sit second and third on goal difference, with Espanyol fourth on four points from two games.

Bundesliga

German champion Bayern Munich picked up where it left off last season, thrashing RB Leipzig 6-0 in its season opener. Star striker Harry Kane bagged a 14-minute second-half hat-trick after a brace from Michael Olise and a debut goal from Luis Diaz had already given the Bavarians a healthy lead.

Former Manchester United manager Erik ten Hag had an underwhelming start to his tenure as Bayer Leverkusen boss, with his side falling to a shock 2-1 home defeat to Hoffenheim.

New signing Jarell Quansah gave the host an early lead, but Fisnik Asllani equalised midway through the first half before Tim Lemperle netted the winner seven minutes after the break.